

2.9.9 Third traffic controller

During single lane shuttle control, a third traffic controller is required when:

- the two traffic controllers cannot see each other, and two-way radios are not available
- a traffic queue gets so long that it approaches a blind corner or crest. Vehicles may not have sufficient chance to stop in time
- controlling traffic at a T-junction. In this situation, it is essential that all three traffic controllers be in two-way communication
- traffic is approaching too fast. The third traffic controller will signal to slow down by using "SLOW" sign facing the traffic, extend the free arm and wave it up and down but not extended above shoulder level
- when it is evident that continuous STOP / SLOW traffic controlling is required, and a break is needed.

2.10 When Things Don't Go to Plan

2.10.1 General

An incident or near miss is an occurrence that in the opinion of the traffic controller affects the operational safety and/or effectiveness of a traffic controller at a worksite or at roadworks and could be caused by anyone interacting with the worksite, including road users, pedestrians and construction workers. This is summarised as:

- incident when actual damage occurred
- near miss when no damage occurred but could have.

Examples of incidents can include:

- accidents occurring within the designated worksite or roadworks
- physical contact or impact with a traffic controller, worker, other road user or equipment, vehicles or the worksite
- assault directed towards a traffic controller by road users
- unsafe or dangerous actions of other road users within a worksite or at roadworks if causing impact or injury
- difficulties experienced with stopping certain vehicle types where damage or impact is caused
- other actions that result in physical contact or injury to a traffic controller.

Examples of near misses can include:

- abusive/insulting/threatening language directed towards a traffic controller
- road users disobeying a direction or signal given by a traffic controller at a designated worksite
- unsafe or dangerous actions of other road users within a worksite or at roadworks
- difficulties experienced with stopping certain vehicle types where no damage is caused
- speeding through a worksite or past a traffic controller.

Near misses are a measure of perception of risk. Reporting near misses assists with identifying events that may result in a future incident (e.g. serious injury or fatality) and can lead to improved practices to prevent this occurring. It is important that any reports of near misses have a description of the 'potential damage scenario,' e.g. a vehicle has run past a traffic control station and may possibly have resulted in actual or potential injury to people, damage to plant/equipment, environment, reputation or the project.